KATHARINE WELLS
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EDUCATION

University of Richmond Richmond, VA
B.A in Sociology | Minor in Data Science & Statistics | GPA:3.8 Expected May 2027

- **Honors:** Dean's List (2023-2026); Phi Eta Sigma National Honor Society (2024-2026)
- **Selected involvement:** Junior Legacy Fellow; Sociology Leadership Committee; UR Diabetes Link; Delta Delta Delta; Club Tennis

RESEARCH AND POLICY EXPERIENCE

University of Richmond Richmond, VA
Live and Learn Research Fellow May 2026-Present

- School of Arts & Sciences Summer Research Fellowship award to study housing, school attendance boundaries, and educational opportunities in metropolitan Richmond
- Built reproducible R and ArcGIS Pro workflows integrating American Community Survey, Virginia Department of Education, housing, and 300,000+ Multiple Listing Service records; applied areal-weighted interpolation across 134 elementary, 40 middle, and 32 high-school zones in eight jurisdictions
- Developed a 13-indicator Live and Learn Opportunity Index spanning housing, education, and socioeconomic conditions; standardized and direction-adjusted measures and validated results against the Child Opportunity Index (Spearman rho = .911-.939, $p < .001$)
- Created policy-facing maps, bivariate visualizations, and regression analyses to communicate racialized and geographic patterns in school opportunity, affordable housing, and neighborhood conditions
- Evaluated school-attendance assignments for 12,524 home sales and found that approximately 12.5% contained at least one inconsistency relative to spatially verified boundaries; translated findings into posters, briefings, and a journal manuscript
- Collaborated with researchers and regional housing partners and prepared work for presentation at VAMLIS 2026 GeoCon, SEDAAG 2026, AAG 2027, AERA 2027, and the 2027 University of Richmond Undergraduate Research Symposium

TEACHING AND ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP

Weinstein Learning Center, University of Richmond Richmond, VA
Content Tutor, Student Manager, and Italian Language Tutor Spring 2026-Present

- Support daily tutoring operations by monitoring five team members' schedules, maintaining a clean and well-run learning environment, and obtaining feedback to ensure students receive appropriate academic support.
- Tutor beginner and intermediate Italian language students through conversation, grammar review, and drill-based practice; adapt explanations to different learning needs and build rapport with students.

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Richmond College Diabetes Network Richmond, VA
President and Panelist Jan 2024-Present

- Organize club events, fundraising, and community engagement initiatives, including advocating for the Screen for Type 1 Diabetes Act to reduce surprise diagnoses
- Lead meetings and panels on navigating college for Type 1 diabetics
- Connect students and families with peer support networks and university support programs

Breakthrough T1D (formerly JDRF) Remote
Youth Ambassador Sep 2018-Present

- Develop social-media outreach through fundraising pages and walk/run events, generating over $4,000 in fundraising for Type 1 diabetes research
- Participate in community outreach programs, coaching students on independent living and disease management

Unite the World with Africa Foundation Dar es Salaam, Tanzania
Field Intern and Volunteer Jun 2022-Present

- Mentor to Tanzanian students through in-person and virtual meetings
- Led First Aid and CPR training for approximately 100 students and staff and supported community sustainability initiatives

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sakonnet Golf Club Little Compton, RI
Manager, Bartender, Server, and Busser May 2021-Aug 2025

- Developed opening and closing procedures for 5 bartenders and 15 servers and directed inventory operations for 20 front-of-house staff.

The Westin, Marriott Hotels South Carolina
Hospitality and Hotel Management Intern May-Jul 2025

- Supported scheduling, inventory monitoring, quality control, and customer service while shadowing supervisors across hotel-management functions

LeafSpring School at Three Chopt Richmond, VA
Teacher's Assistant (Part-Time, ~ 20 hours/week) Jan-Jun 2024

- Supported early-childhood instruction and care for 75 children across five classrooms
- Cultivated trusted relationships with families and peer educators

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND POLICY INTERESTS

- **Technical:** ArcGIS Pro; R/RStudio (sf, tidycensus, dplyr, ggplot2); Python; Microsoft Excel and PowerPoint; Google Workspace
- **Methods:** spatial data integration; areal interpolation; geocoding and spatial joins; composite-index construction; regression and correlation; data visualization
- **Communication:** research posters, presentations; tutoring, mentorship; team coordination
- **Policy interests:** urban planning; education policy; public policy; housing affordability; school attendance boundaries; spatial inequality